Category Policy Addendum: Sports & Outdoors

Kartway Operations Policy Addendum: Sports & Outdoors
Document ID: POL-SO-4412 Effective Date: 14 January 2025
Applies To: All Tier-1 and Tier-2 Customer Support Agents, Resolution Specialists, and Returns Processing Teams

1. Scope and Precedence

1.1 This addendum governs all customer operations, returns, refunds, warranty claims, and hazardous materials handling for orders placed within the Sports & Outdoors category on the Kartway marketplace.

1.2 Where provisions in this document conflict with the general Kartway Customer Operations Manual (POL-GEN-100), the clauses in this addendum shall supersede for all Sports & Outdoors merchandise.

2. Return Window

2.1 The standard return window for Sports & Outdoors items is 30 days from the actual delivery date recorded by the carrier. No extensions, grace periods, or manager overrides shall be granted beyond the 30-day threshold.
2.2 Return requests initiated on day 31 post-delivery or later shall be automatically rejected by the returns portal and must not be manually overridden by support agents.

3. Condition Requirements and Opened Items

3.1 Items returned due to a change of mind must be in re-sellable condition, complete with all included accessories, manuals, and component parts.
3.2 An opened item returned for a change of mind is accepted under Kartway policy, but carries a mandatory restocking fee of 12% of the total amount paid by the customer (excluding outbound shipping charges).
3.3 The restocking fee of 12% shall be automatically calculated and deducted from the refund disbursement by the payment gateway module.

4. Return Pickup Fees

4.1 For all change-of-mind returns requiring a carrier pickup, a return pickup fee of 99 rupees shall be charged to the customer.
4.2 The 99 rupees pickup fee shall be directly deducted from the final refund amount processed to the customer’s original payment instrument.
4.3 The 99 rupees fee is non-refundable even if the returned item was part of a multi-item shipment where other items were retained.

5. Original Packaging Mandate

5.1 Original manufacturer packaging is not mandatory for returns within the Sports & Outdoors category.
5.2 Customers may use alternative secure shipping cartons or poly-mailers for return transit, provided the lack of original packaging did not occur due to customer negligence rendering the item un-inspectable. Support agents shall not deny a return solely on the absence of the original box or sleeve.

6. Damaged, Wrong, or Defective Items

6.1 Any item received in a damaged, incorrect, or defective condition must be formally reported by the customer within 30 days of delivery.
6.2 Approved claims for damaged, wrong, or defective items shall be refunded in full (100% of the amount paid, inclusive of original shipping fees).
6.3 Zero fees (no restocking fee, no pickup fee) shall be applied to returns processed under the damaged, wrong, or defective classification.

7. Category-Specific Handling Rules: Restricted and Safety Items

7.1 Protective Gear: Helmets, climbing harnesses, life vests, and other safety-critical protective gear are strictly not accepted back once used. Agents must verify via customer declaration and visual inspection photos that the item shows zero signs of wear, strapping adjustment, impact, or field deployment before issuing a return merchandise authorization (RMA).
7.2 Hazmat and Fuel: Gas canisters, liquid camping stove fuel, pressurized bear sprays, and any other hazardous chemical or compressed gas products are strictly non-returnable under any circumstance (including change of mind and defective claims). For defective hazmat items, agents must issue a direct refund without requiring physical return transit.

8. Warranty Position

8.1 Sports & Outdoors products do not carry a uniform category-wide warranty. Products carry the specific warranty period explicitly shown on their individual product listing page at the time of purchase.
8.2 Valid warranty periods are strictly limited to one of the following four values: none, 6 months, 12 months, or 24 months.
8.3 The warranty coverage period is counted strictly from the exact delivery date recorded by the logistics provider.
8.4 Claims falling outside the stated warranty period (e.g., month 13 on a 12-month warranty item) must be rejected by support agents, with the customer redirected to the manufacturer where applicable.